

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-II

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

Q1. Differentiate the role of B.N. Rau from that of the Drafting Committee in Indian constitution-making.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (147 words; practice model, not official): B.N. Rau and the Drafting Committee occupied successive but distinct stages. As Constitutional Adviser, Rau organised comparative research, advised committees and prepared an initial adviser draft in 1947. His work widened the menu of constitutional techniques and converted committee materials into a preliminary legal architecture. The seven-member Drafting Committee, appointed on 29 August 1947 under B.R. Ambedkar, scrutinised that material, reconciled committee decisions and prepared the Draft Constitution published in February 1948 and revised in October 1948. Ambedkar then introduced and defended the Draft in the Assembly. S.N. Mukerjee supplied technical legislative drafting. Neither Rau nor the Committee possessed final constituent authority. The plenary Assembly debated clauses, moved amendments and adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949. Rau prepared and advised; the Committee legally integrated and piloted; the Assembly authorised. This differentiation credits Ambedkar's exceptional leadership without reducing a distributed process to solitary authorship.

Q2. Explain why corporate social responsibility in India is a statutory obligation rather than philanthropy, and what follows for development outcomes.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (92 words; practice model, not official): Section 135 creates a bounded statutory minimum spend rather than a voluntary gift, which both prevents diversion and crowds funders into legible Schedule VII sectors, so the statutory character explains the pattern of what actually gets funded. A Section 8 company is incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 for promoting charitable objects and is prohibited from distributing profits or paying dividends to its members, so it carries board governance and Companies Act disclosure at a higher compliance cost, which is why it is used mainly by larger professionalised foundations and non-governmental organisations.

Q3. Explain how poverty and malnutrition reinforce each other and identify the interventions that can break the cycle.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (117 words; practice model, not official): The loop is intergenerational and multi-causal, so analysis should trace deprivation through undernutrition, impaired development and low human capital back to low earnings, then attach named multi-sectoral levers rather than a single-scheme remedy. The window from conception to the age of two is the period during which nutritional deprivation causes irreversible stunting and cognitive impairment, so interventions placed inside it yield the highest return, and this is the reason the nutrition mission is designed around pregnancy, lactation and the child under two rather than around the school-age child alone; in an answer, the window supplies the sequencing argument, because it explains why adolescent-girl and maternal nutrition are treated as child-nutrition instruments rather than as separate welfare heads.

Q4. Why is the Indian Constitution better described as adapted rather than copied?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (142 words; practice model, not official): The Indian Constitution borrowed tested devices but did not reproduce any one foreign system. Britain supplied cabinet responsibility, rule of law, writs and single citizenship; India rejected hereditary monarchy and unlimited parliamentary sovereignty. The United States influenced Fundamental Rights and judicial review; India rejected presidential government, rigid separation and dual citizenship. Canada influenced a strong-Centre federation, while Ireland supplied Directive Principles and Australia the Concurrent List. The Government of India Act, 1935 supplied much administrative machinery, including federal, gubernatorial, service and emergency provisions. Yet popular sovereignty, universal adult franchise, republican government, enforceable rights and responsible ministries changed the authority and purpose of that machinery. Borrowing therefore describes genealogy; adaptation describes constitutional design. The residual caution is that inherited centralising and legalistic habits can survive. India's originality lies in a parliamentary federation combining rights, social directives, single citizenship, judicial review and democratic transformation.

Q5. Explain why a civil-society organisation is a non-State actor even when its advocacy is perceived as adversarial.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (101 words; practice model, not official): Non-state is a structural and legal category while anti-State is a political label, so the appropriate governance response to disagreement is disclosure and engagement rather than reclassification of a constitutional freedom as a suspicion. A civil-society organisation is a non-state actor as a matter of structure and law because it is not part of government, whereas anti-State is a perceptual and political label applied when advocacy, funding source or activity is seen as opposing state policy, so collapsing the structural category into the political judgment converts a constitutional freedom into a suspicion and is precisely the trap the 2025 demand tests.

Q6. Distinguish the two pillars of Ayushman Bharat and explain how they jointly serve universal health coverage.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (117 words; practice model, not official): The two pillars address different rungs of the care hierarchy and different edges of the coverage cube, so analysis should define each precisely, connect them through the referral spine and close by naming the dimension that remains weakest. The financing chain runs from revenue collection through risk pooling and strategic purchasing to service provision, and available evidence indicates that the decisive consequence that insurance without public primary care leaves prevention, medicines and outpatient out-of-pocket expenditure unresolved; this is the analytical core of any question about financial protection, because hospitalisation cover addresses the catastrophic tail while the recurring outpatient and medicine burden, which is where most household health spending actually occurs, is addressed only by funded primary provision.

Q7. The Preamble is part of the Constitution, yet it confers no power and bars none. Examine.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (125 words; practice model, not official): The apparent contradiction disappears when three questions are separated. First, membership: Berubari Union (1960) treated the Preamble as an interpretive key but not as part; Kesavananda Bharati (1973) displaced that exclusion, and LIC of India (1995) reaffirmed integral status. Second, enforceability: the Preamble remains non-justiciable and creates no standalone cause of action. Third, competence: legislative power comes from provisions such as Articles 245-246 and the Seventh Schedule, not from Preambular ideals; nor does the Preamble independently prohibit legislation. Its force is nevertheless real. It guides the interpretation of ambiguous provisions and helps identify basic features when an amendment is reviewed under Article 368. Thus the Preamble is constitutional text with derivative legal force—an authoritative interpretive charter, but not an autonomous grant of power or remedy.

Q8. Distinguish digitisation from e-governance and explain why the distinction decides whether a government portal improves an outcome.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (111 words; practice model, not official): Digitisation renders an existing process on a screen while e-governance redesigns the process around the citizen, so the distinction is not terminological: it predicts whether a portal removes the delay or automates it, and it is the only opening that lets an answer locate the defect rather than describe the interface. Digitisation is the conversion of paper records and processes into digital form and is the precondition of e-governance rather than its goal, because e-governance requires the service or process itself to be redesigned around the citizen; digitising an unreformed process automates the delay instead of removing it, which is why a technically complete portal can reproduce the opacity it replaced.

Q9. Comment on the earn-while-you-learn approach and its contribution to meaningful vocational education and skilling.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (118 words; practice model, not official): The design is not contested while its conditions are, so the comment must name the apprenticeship and qualification instruments, then argue stigma, employer participation, counselling and matching as the binding constraints. The skills ecosystem recorded by the owners consists of the national skill mission for training, the National Council for Vocational Education and Training as the unified regulator of skill qualifications, awarding bodies and assessment agencies under the skill-development ministry, replacing earlier fragmented regulators, the National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme which provides stipend support to employers hiring apprentices in order to bridge classroom training and workplace learning, and the national skills qualification framework, a competency-based hierarchy of ten levels enabling recognition, certification and mobility across formal and non-formal training.

Q10. "The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy." Elucidate.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (112 words; practice model, not official): Article 75(3) makes the cabinet responsible to Lok Sabha, yet the same fusion can let the executive dominate its scrutineer. A disciplined majority and Tenth Schedule-backed whip reduce independent

legislative voting. Cabinet control of House time, guillotining of grants and limited committee referral compress scrutiny. Delegated legislation, ordinances under Article 123 and an overbroad Money Bill route can further reduce prior parliamentary examination; PM-centred coordination concentrates agenda power. Parliament nevertheless retains no-confidence, Question Hour, motions, DRSC and PAC-CAG scrutiny, while courts enforce constitutional limits. Thus, cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's deliberative and control functions, not created British-style sovereignty. More sittings, routine committee referral and narrower whip use are the appropriate correctives.

Q11. Section 6A is constitutionally valid, but its implementation remains a governance challenge. Analyse in light of the 2024 Constitution Bench judgment.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (199 words; practice model, not official): Thesis: The 4:1 judgment separates the validity of Assam's historical settlement from the adequacy of its enforcement. Scheme: Section 6A deems pre-1966 Indian-origin entrants citizens; subjects the 1966-before-25 March 1971 stream to detection, registration and a ten-year electoral exclusion; and protects no post-cut-off entrant. Majority: Chief Justice Chandrachud and Justice Surya Kant's three-judge opinion upheld Parliament's Article 11 competence and found Assam plus the 1971 date to be a reasonable classification. They rejected challenges under Articles 6, 7, 9, 14, 21, 29, 326 and 355; Article 29 protects the capacity to conserve culture, and destruction of that capacity was not proved. Governance deficit: Justice Surya Kant nevertheless found tribunals and statutory machinery inadequate, stressed detection/deportation of post-1971 entrants, effective use of complementary laws and continuing judicial monitoring. Dissent: Justice Pardiwala argued that the absence of temporal closure and State-centred detection burden made Section 6A(3) manifestly arbitrary with time; he would invalidate prospectively while preserving past grants. Assessment: The dissent identifies design risk, but the majority controls. Administrative failure cannot be casually converted into invalidity; nor can validity excuse indefinite non-enforcement. Conclusion: Section 6A survives as law, but legitimacy now depends on timely, rights-respecting and reviewable implementation.

Q12. Examine the claim that India's good-governance deficits lie in enforceable conversion mechanisms rather than in the absence of norms.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (176 words; practice model, not official): India has not lacked good-governance norms but enforceable conversion mechanisms, which is why the reforms that supplied an identifiable duty-holder and a remedy have moved outcomes further than any additional charter of principles. The Second Administrative Reforms Commission, constituted in 2005 and reporting through fifteen reports, supplies the India-specific institutional-reform frame, and India deliberately enforces the good-governance standard through a patchwork of sector laws such as the Right to Information Act, state right-to-service Acts and Section 17 of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act rather than through a single overarching good-governance statute. Rule of law is anchored in Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned quasi-judicial orders whose discipline is uneven below the regulator tier, transparency in Section 4 proactive disclosure under the Right to Information Act, 2005 whose compliance is not independently audited across authorities, and accountability in the Comptroller and Auditor General under Articles 148 to 151, the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 and the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003, which supply three different remedies and none of which is a general grievance authority.

Q13. Assess the claim that India's welfare architecture has moved from discretionary charity to enforceable entitlement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (146 words; practice model, not official): The framing has moved further than the delivery, because statutory entitlements now exist alongside a large targeted-scheme layer while funding, identification and remedy remain the binding constraints, so the assessment must be graded and must name the gap at which the claim fails. Rights-based welfare frames the citizen as an entitlement-holder with a statutory or constitutional claim and a remedy where the law provides one, whereas charity-based welfare treats support as state beneficence that may be withdrawn at discretion, and the National Food Security Act, 2013 and the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 are the standard Indian illustrations of the shift from scheme to claim; the qualification carried by the owners is decisive and must always be written, namely that a statutory label alone does not guarantee delivery and that an under-funded entitlement converts a legal right into a paper promise.

Q14. Examine the claim that strategic autonomy is best understood as a method of instrument selection rather than as a fixed alliance preference.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (160 words; practice model, not official): Autonomy is a method because available evidence indicates that a five-level instrument toolkit and an evidentiary hierarchy that force each interest to be routed to the level that suits it, so the examination must run the results chain, name the level, cite one dated instrument with its exact evidentiary level, and close with the constraint that bounds the claim. The analytical framework of this folder defines national interest as the set of security, economic-growth and resource, technology, diaspora-welfare, reputation and rule-shaping, and strategic-autonomy goals that guide external conduct, and it fixes the answer chain as interest, then external context or actor, then instrument chosen, then verified outcome, then constraint or

trade-off, then calibrated way forward; the operational consequence is that an answer which opens with a country list or a summit list has skipped the only step that makes the rest of the analysis evaluable, because the instrument can only be judged against the interest it was chosen to serve.

Q15. Asymmetrical federalism is an instrument of integration, not a departure from equal citizenship. Examine.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (206 words; practice model, not official): Asymmetrical federalism means that territorial units possess different constitutional arrangements within one sovereign order. It seeks substantive integration by responding to different histories, identities and governing conditions. The Fifth Schedule protects Scheduled Areas through a Governor and Tribes Advisory Council framework. The Sixth Schedule creates autonomous district and regional councils in specified tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. Articles 371 to 371J contain distinct State-specific provisions; they are not one uniform privilege. Article 239AA gives Delhi an elected legislature and ministry while excluding public order, police and land from its ordinary field. These arrangements can reduce alienation, protect land and customary institutions, and permit metropolitan or border-specific governance. They therefore strengthen the Union by making membership compatible with meaningful difference. Risks remain. Complexity can obscure accountability; exceptional powers may be under-implemented; and unequal treatment may become politically contested. The post-2019 J&K arrangement also shows that asymmetry can be reduced through constitutional action. The 2023 Article 370 judgment upheld the changes but did not fix a date for restoration of statehood. Asymmetry does not create different grades of Indian citizenship. Its legitimacy depends on constitutional purpose, participation, rights and periodic review. Equality requires equal citizenship, not necessarily identical territorial institutions. Answer-prose count: 202 words.

Q16. Examine the aims of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 and the separate question of its coverage.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (177 words; practice model, not official): The aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and conflating the two is precisely the error the scope half of the demand is designed to expose. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses.

Q17. Critically examine the claim that the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005 secures effective access to justice for aggrieved women.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (177 words; practice model, not official): The Act is generous in scope and dependent in delivery, so the critical examination must accept the breadth of the domestic relationship and the reliefs, then test access against Protection Officer capacity, the contested shared-household right and the difference between registered cases and prevalence. The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005 is recorded by the owners as primarily a civil and protective statute rather than a general penal code for domestic violence: an aggrieved woman may approach a Protection Officer or a Magistrate for a protection order, a residence order and monetary relief, and the implementing arm named in the Act is the Protection Officer; the criminal edge is precise and narrow, because breach of a protection order is an offence under Section 31, while cruelty may separately attract prosecution under the general penal law, so the accurate formulation is that the Act supplies civil remedies backed by a criminal consequence for breach, and describing it either as wholly civil or as a general criminal statute for domestic violence is the trap the owners flag.

Q18. Examine the observation that regional-framework cooperation appeals more to India's smaller neighbours than purely bilateral engagement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (141 words; practice model, not official): The preference is structural rather than tactical because numbers supply reassurance against asymmetry, so the examination must state Sikri's finding, distinguish smaller from larger neighbours, and qualify it with the fact that substantive connectivity work still proceeds bilaterally while the regional overlay supplies political reassurance. Sikri records that smaller neighbours like Bhutan, Nepal, Maldives and Sri Lanka have shown greater interest in economic integration with India than the larger ones like Pakistan and Bangladesh, and that they are more receptive to cooperation within a regional framework than on a bilateral basis because numbers give them a sense of greater security, which the owners treat as a structural rather than merely tactical preference; the necessary qualification is that this preference does not amount to rejecting bilateral

engagement, because the substantive connectivity work still proceeds bilaterally while the regional overlay supplies political reassurance.

Q19. Examine whether All-India Services strengthen administrative unity at an excessive cost to State autonomy.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (194 words; practice model, not official): Article 312 permits common services for Union and States after a Rajya Sabha national-interest resolution. IAS, IPS and Indian Forest Service embody India's integrated administrative federalism. Benefits: Common recruitment and training establish professional standards, enable movement of experience across States and Union, and provide continuity during crises. Officers serving State cadres possess local administrative knowledge while connecting implementation to national law and programmes. Ambedkar's "strategic posts" rationale remains relevant for a diverse federation. Autonomy costs: Cadre allocation, deputation, disciplinary control and central empanelment can create divided accountability. States may perceive officer shortages or recall/deputation disputes as Union pressure. Uniform career incentives can also weaken responsiveness to local political priorities. The design is not inherently anti-federal because officers work under State governments in State posts and new services require Rajya Sabha approval. The problem arises when shared control becomes unilateral command. Reform should use transparent deputation rules, meaningful State consultation, predictable cadre strength, protection against partisan transfer, and joint performance frameworks. Specialised State services should be strengthened rather than displaced. Thus, All-India Services are a federal bridge, not merely a centralising instrument. Their legitimacy depends on genuinely shared personnel governance. Answer-prose count: 190 words.

Q20. Examine whether digital illiteracy in rural areas, coupled with limited access to information and communication technology, has hindered socio-economic development.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (161 words; practice model, not official): Digital illiteracy is a stack of six separable constraints rather than a single deficit, and its developmental damage arises at the moment the digital route becomes the only route, so the design obligation runs the other way and a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS